



ELEVATE MENTORSHIP PROGRAMME
CLOSE-OUT REPORT
12 AUGUST 2024

CONTENTS

Background.....	1
Objectives	1
Scope and approach	1
Project implementation.....	2
Project set up.....	2
Onboarding.....	2
Launch	3
First meeting.....	3
Subsequent meetings	3
Mentor connect call	3
Mentee connect call.....	3
One-on-one connect calls.....	3
Close-out Session.....	3
Participant attendance and feedback	4
Attendance	4
Close-out survey feedback	5
Close-out session feedback	7
Lessons Learned	9
Annexure: Partnerships	10

BACKGROUND

Mentorship has proven to be a powerful and effective workforce development tool, and a means to retain IDC's institutional memory. This practice has been operationalized in the development of Dealmakers where SMEs in Operations Academy capacitate newly registered CAs/Engineers with the critical competencies for an experienced Dealmaker. This practice also extends to the various Business Units in Operations where trainees on this programme are assigned to an experienced senior professional for the necessary support and guidance on the job.

You found that these approaches to mentorship were insufficient to efficiently develop millennials who tend to lean towards unconventional methods of learning. In addition, you found that traditional mentorship had also become insufficient to further your aims of developing a complex and multigenerational workforce; managing capacity requirements and succession planning; and accelerating the development of Industry specific skills.

You therefore instituted this mentorship programme to enable leaders across all levels within the IDC to proactively transfer skills and build capabilities. This programme needed to extend beyond traditional means to build capabilities for different populations of employees and to include various mentorship approaches to accelerating the development of people through creative methods of upskilling people beyond formal classroom training.

OBJECTIVES

The overarching aim of the programme was to make mentorship a vehicle for accelerated employee development within a complex and multigenerational workforce. The intended outcomes were:

- For the Organisation A strong and well-run internal mentorship programme that would:
 - Provide a holistic practice that extends beyond traditional means to build capabilities for different populations of employees
 - Enable leaders across all levels of work within the IDC to proactively transfer skills and build capabilities.
 - Manage capacity requirements and succession planning through adopting creative methods of upskilling people beyond the formal classroom training.
- For mentors: Fulfilment from building the next generation of leaders and developing talent within the organisation while increasing their own professional and interpersonal skills, insights and perspectives
- For mentees Personal and career development, added confidence, new networks and a strong foundation to achieve at higher levels through curated mentorship relationships with group mentors.

SCOPE AND APPROACH

The programme consisted of 50 mentees and 20 mentors from within IDC staff. The programme ran for 12 months including preparation and wrap up, and the interactions were either online or face-to-face depending on accessibility.

We implemented a group mentorship approach with two co-mentors assigned to each group. This approach enabled learning and collaboration between all mentors and mentees, thus widening the perspectives offered and support available to each individual participant.

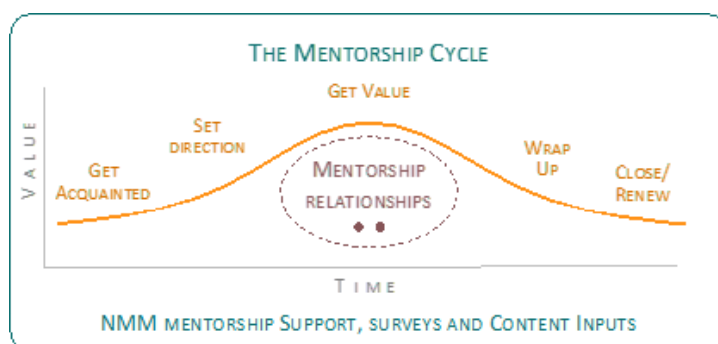
We established 11 groups, each one consisting of the 2 co-mentors and 5-7 mentees who had identified similar skills development areas. We paired the co-mentors based on gender and specific areas of expertise and level of management.

We also created one-on-one partnerships for two participants, one with an internal IDC staff member as a mentor and one with an external mentor – see the Annexure for a list of the participants.

PROJECT IMPLEMENTATION

PROJECT SET UP

National Mentorship Movement (NMM) worked with the IDC in the beginning phases of the programme to establish an appropriate model for group mentorship within the IDC. The model was based on NMM's model of get acquainted, set direction, get value, and wrap up and close, as shown below:



We set up a project team, consisting of IDC's Jillian Arends and NMM's Dave Wilson (CEO), Ros Solomon (Programme Executive), Claire Gemmill (Project Manager), Zamokuhle Masina (Operational & Relationship Manager), and Neo Moloi (RAPA - Relationship Agent and Project Assistant).

NMM set up a dedicated IDC white labelled pathway on the online platform to guide the participants through their onboarding process with relevant material, to enable participants to register their details, to trigger regular surveys and provide a source of relevant material. In addition, we invited the participants to the monthly NMM learning platform events which we hold in partnership with the Global Society for Organisational Learning (Global SOL).

Together, the IDC and NMM drafted an appeal to mobilise 22 mentors and 52 mentees onto the programme. We sent participants a link to register their details and mentorship needs on the platform. NMM performed a matching exercise on the platform, using the algorithm and registration questions to match participants. Following that exercise, the IDC and NMM engaged in a manual exercise to review the groups produced by the platform to ensure best fit for each participant on the programme.

ONBOARDING

NMM hosted a 2-hour online mentor training on 27 September 2023, facilitated by Ros Solomon, where mentors were oriented to the group mentorship model, and trained in various mentorship skills. She also took the mentors through the Mentor Field Guide, a structured document filled with resources to guide mentors through their group sessions.

LAUNCH

The IDC and NMM held a 2-hour hybrid launch event on 29 September 2023, those in Johannesburg attending in person, and those outside the region online. This session provided further insight into the group mentorship process, roles and responsibilities and expectations, as well as an opportunity to introduce participants to their groups, and engage in their first mentorship session.

FIRST MEETING

An NMM facilitator attended each group's initial meeting for the first 15 minutes and supported them in establishing the foundation for their further mentorship sessions. During this meeting, we covered the following points:

1. Identifying which platform they would meet on - Teams, in-person, or a hybrid approach
2. Establishing and scheduling regular meetings (once a month)
3. Setting up a WhatsApp group to communicate between monthly meetings, and to provide apologies in the event of someone unable to attend.

SUBSEQUENT MEETINGS

Each mentorship group created their own structure of when they met, how regularly, and in what format (ie. online, in-person, hybrid). The structure they developed was based on several factors, including but not limited to:

- Geographic location
- Department and level of management as it relates to year end pressure and workload
- Interpersonal dynamics of group members
- Flexibility of mentors and mentees and ability to meet beyond formal structures
- Openness and vulnerability of group members and the connection they established as a result.

In addition, their feedback indicates that there are other interactions outside the meetings, that the mentees were open to receiving significant value, and the mentors are also learned a great deal.

MENTOR CONNECT CALL

On 6 February 2024, the team hosted a 1-hour online mentor connect call. The purpose of this call was to revitalize the mentorship programme and gain feedback from the mentors on their experience of the programme thus far, any challenges and questions they have around the process. The call was attended by 14 mentors, who gave feedback on their highlights and lowlights from the programme.

The team thanked the mentors for their open and honest feedback, which gave a full picture of how mentors on the programme are experiencing the group mentorship process. Neo asked mentors to add him to their WhatsApp group so that he could continue to track meetings and attendance, and reminded the mentors to complete their surveys on the platform so that we can continue to improve the programme.

MENTEE CONNECT CALL

On 13 March 2024, the team hosted a 1-hour online mentee connect call. The purpose was to check in with the mentees, understand how they've been experiencing the programme and their group sessions. Mentees gave feedback shared in the next section on the highlights and lowlights of the programme for them.

ONE-ON-ONE CONNECT CALLS

Ros Solomon performed individual connect calls with the one-on-one mentees on this programme.

CLOSE-OUT SESSION

We hosted an online connection and close-out call with mentors and mentees on 30 May 2024, from 10:00-11:30, where participants were able to share and celebrate their growth throughout the programme.

PARTICIPANT ATTENDANCE AND FEEDBACK

ATTENDANCE

We asked each group to allocate one mentee to send our RAPA Neo Moloi their group members mobile numbers and monthly attendance records to track meetings and attendance. We drafted email communication, and Jillian sent it out to all participants with the IDC Elevate Mentorship programme branding. We also ensured that Ros, or Claire, and Jillian attended each of the group's first meetings to emphasise the importance of sending these records and communicating their details with us.

Despite this, the response rates from mentors and mentees were low and Neo struggled to reach participants to obtain these records. At a later stage in the programme, when the team hosted separate mentor and mentee connect calls, we requested that participants add Neo to their WhatsApp groups so he could track communication and record when the meetings occurred. Only one group did so.

At the mentor connect call on 9 April 2024, we asked mentors how many meetings they had with their groups, and how many mentees on average were in attendance. Their responses are reflected below:

Claire Gemmill (External) 10:34



How many meetings have you had? On average, how many mentees have attended those meetings?



Peter Mokomele 10:37



We have had 4 meetings - there are 4 mentees but there would always be 1 or 2 absent due to other commitments. At the last one we had invited HC to assist on one of the questions that had been raised by 3 of the mentees and it well.



Ilze Adonis 10:39



I think we've had 3 meetings with the next one being coming Thursday making it 4 - i hope we can have all mentees there. Kugan's secretary is organizing the meetings for us. I will ask her to remind the mentees of the meeting 😊



Chisakula Kaputu 10:40



Chisakula & Imtiaz team: ideally every 2nd Thursday of every month. In person at IDC HQ with virtual attendance by those out of town/ out of station. Mostly both Mentors attend with atleast 3 mentees (out of 5) each time we have met. Hope for things to get better..... Thanks





Chawulani Ndimande 10:41

We've had 3 sessions so far with the fourth one scheduled for today. In two sessions we had everyone in attendance and the one session there were 1 or 2 mentees absent.

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Rika Gopichund 10:42

once a month on a Friday, we have one formal session with all in attendance and several informal corridor discussions including 1 or 2 mentees only. All linked on a whatsapp chat

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Pieter de Beer 10:45

Marianna & Pieter: 4 Meetings, 3/4 attendees in each meeting. Not the same absentee in meetings. Next meeting 19/4. Some informal discussions in between.



Gavin Smith 10:45

[Nathan](#) & I have 6 other IDCans in our group, and have had 5 formal meetings (next one Thurs)

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Lloyd Hlengani 10:45

Japhet and I have had two meetings with the meeting. We unfortunately experienced the loss of a mentor and two mentees. We have a monthly meeting for our team. All 3 mentees have consistently attended every meeting. We have also had individual meetings with them.

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Every group was represented on the connect call, and except for one that had met once only, the majority had met three of four times and the feedback indicates that there were interactions outside the meetings, that the mentees were open to receiving significant value, and the mentors are also learned a great deal.

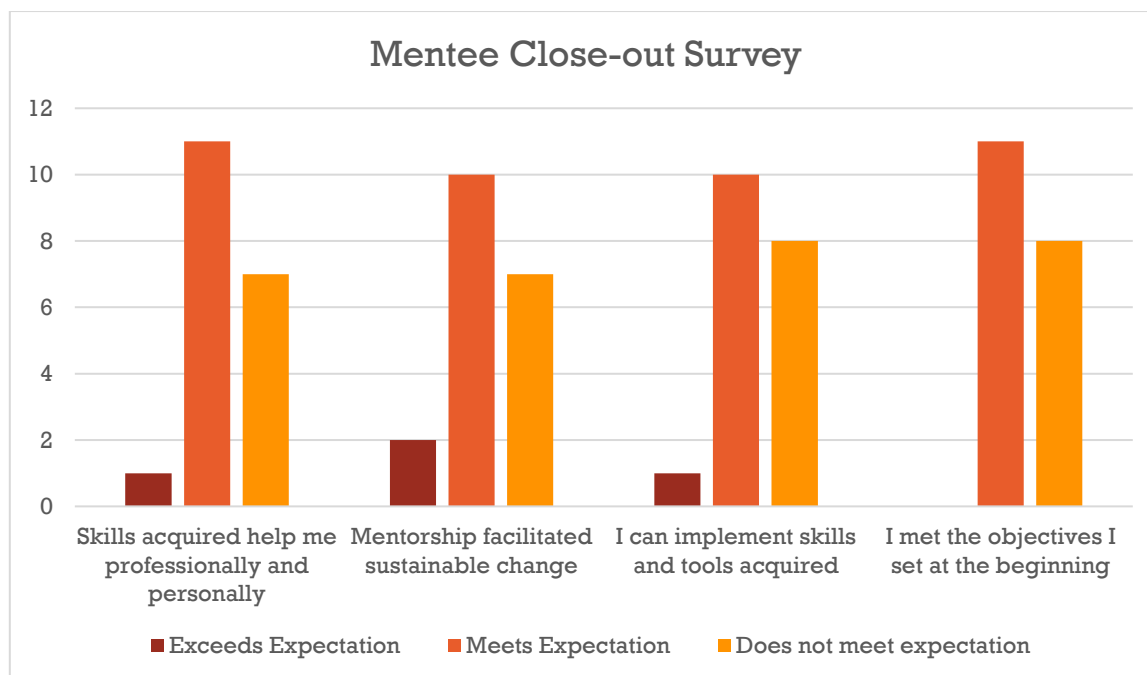
CLOSE-OUT SURVEY FEEDBACK

The following are the questions and results of the close out survey.

MENTEE CLOSE-OUT SURVEY

We carried out a close-out survey through the platform, with 19 mentees responding to the following questions:

- The skills I acquired through my mentorship journey help me in my professional and personal life
- My mentorship journey facilitated sustainable change in my life
- I can implement the new skills and tools I have acquired throughout my mentoring journey
- I have met the mentorship objectives that I set at the beginning of my journey



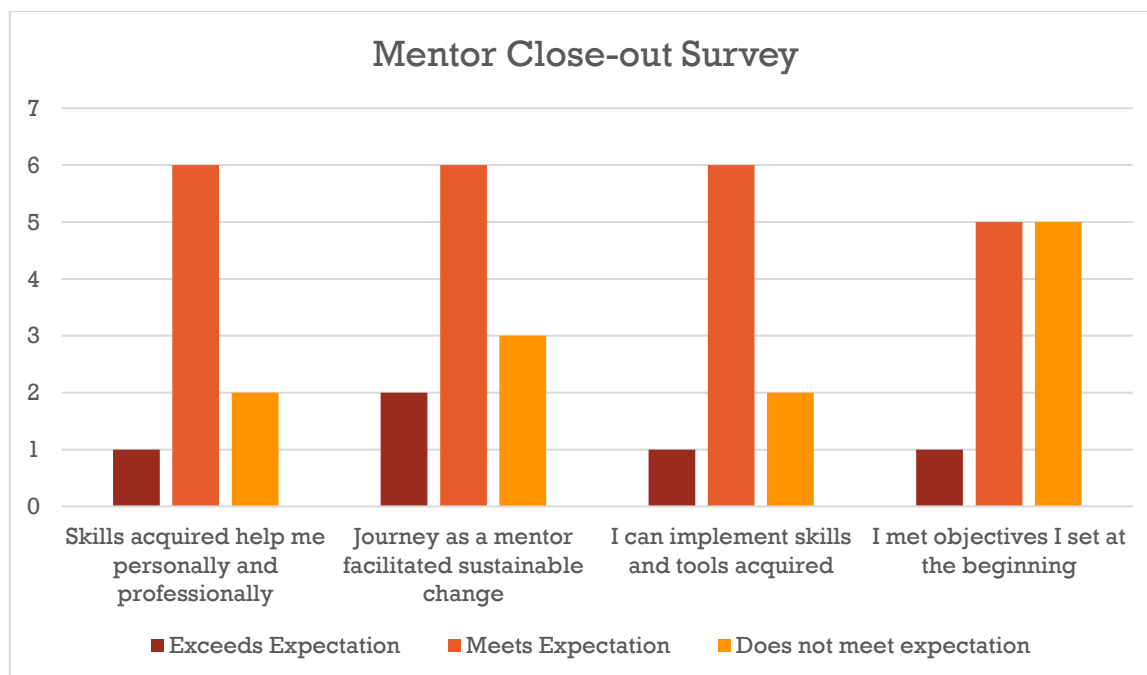
Mentees gave the following comments on their overall experience of the programme:

- Kugan has always provided in house advise to add to my growth and development
- Thatisi is well knowledgeable and shares it so freely and passionately.
- Meeting and engaging with others. The networks built through this and the engagements had been great.
- The one meeting that I have had with my mentor has been a great start of the journey.
- Move out of your comfort zone. Record achievements and work on failures. Attempt to see if what you think you can do is doable. Mentorship is great because I got to see what others see in me and I never thought I possess. Thank you.
- I have not been able to commit to any of the mentorship requirements. An issue on my side completely as I had a very high workload that had me so overwhelmed most of the time. I then chose to focus on my studies and the other leadership programme I was nominated for. It really was an issue of prioritizing so I do not find myself completely burnt out.
- The affirmation that the corporation is starting to see mentorship as critical to continued growth amongst professionals which will translate to sustainability of the organization
- Maybe Mentees should be guided or given training on how to go about, yes maybe it not the first time that they are doing this but what are we trying to achieve and guide them on what you as the service are hoping to achieve
- Did not experience much mentoring
- My mentor and I have not made any contact. At this point I am unable to rate any progress Mae to date.
- Due to the people with various backgrounds in the group there was no common ground developed. It could be beneficial to group people with similar roles together eg. dealmakers, risk, HR
- The best aspect was meeting more people who work at the Sandton office of the IDC. I believe these networks will come in handy in the future.
- The process has been slow and we have not met up

MENTOR CLOSE-OUT SURVEY

Nine mentors responded to the following questions:

- The skills I acquired through my mentorship journey help me in my professional and personal life
- My journey as a mentor facilitated sustainable change in my life
- I can implement the new skills and tools I have acquired throughout my mentoring experience
- I have met the mentorship objectives that I set at the beginning of my journey.



Mentors gave the following comments on their experience of the programme:

- Sharing learning, experiences and making others do better than yourself in your career
- The best aspects were when I resonated with my mentees and they set out what they wanted to achieve. However there was more time needed as we just touched the surface and they needed more help/intervention - this is a journey and not a 6 month stint - the meetings weren't regular and the group setting was unproductive as the mentees preferred to be with me only and not with a male or in a group due to personal matters that were impacting their work life balance.
- Hopefully I was able to support and help the mentees
- I enjoyed the group mentoring - I usually do 1 on 1 with little formal group work.
- I have learned a new set of tools and skills in this programme. Specifically, regarding the dynamic tools necessary to engage and deal with more than one mentee in a group setup which I haven't done before. These tools I believe will remain valuable in my relationships in general.
- Seeing the change in other people (mentees) from when they started to where they are now and the tools, they must manage challenges faced in their professional and personal lives. With the hope that some of the information and knowledge shared translates into action.
- Starting the program, I wanted to contribute better. The group dynamics were challenging: choosing appropriate dates, time, duration and choice of topics. Some value was delivered, acknowledged by mentees and co-mentor. However, I believe with better insight and appropriate preparation, I could've contributed better. I am not sure that the assigned mentees were satisfied. More time (longer period) would've helped. All-in-all, I believe the journey was too short and specifics mentioned in the previous surveys complicated optimal delivery.

CLOSE-OUT SESSION FEEDBACK

At the close-out call on 30 May 2024, mentees and mentors gave feedback on their experience of the programme, their groups and what they gained from the mentorship journey. The team captured the feedback as follows:

GROUP MENTEES

- The mentorship programme was a safe space to speak, offload and destress. Everyone is trying to balance life, overwhelmed, fatigued. It's comforting to know I'm not the only one feeling that way and there are others trying to find a balance and can share and assist each other in finding solutions. We learned from one another and discovered some common goals. It was a fulfilling experience to have space to engage on that level.

- We as mentors also learn from mentees sharing their experience. We first made the space safe so people can share and open up. Mentees could also share their wisdom freely (not just mentors). It was a beautiful journey and I appreciated mentees freely sharing their work and personal experiences.
- Mentors created a safe space for us to share without fear, both personally and with work. I realized that our mentors could mentor us in all means possible, the ball was in my court and I had to act on all I wanted to achieve by being courageous in what I want. I had to realize my strengths and weaknesses and how I can position myself to get to where I want to go. We can really learn from our mentors' experiences. This went beyond mentorship.
- I appreciated the safe space from my mentors and the support they gave. Also, the support from other mentees who had respect and created a safe space.
- We had a slow start still figuring out the team, our roles and objectives. I'm happy with our progress and the traction we made. A safe space was important – we received mentorship across the aspects of life, it was not a narrow focus. My mentor opened my mind, added a lot of value to me, and this will go beyond the programme timelines.
- I didn't join the sessions due to my work schedule.
- My mentor is approachable and always willing to assist. We still need more time with each other!
- Time is the biggest enemy to mentorship. The year end start and deliverables in April made this challenging. It is important for the group to show up.
- A few times the group did not meet (it was never the entire group). It was quite beneficial. I took a lot from the talks, though we didn't have time to meet as often as we should have. It would have been far more beneficial if we all met and learned from each other.

ONE-ON-ONE MENTEE

- I am meeting the person I've become, and I really like her! When we first started it was uncomfortable – I was challenged to introspect, ask difficult questions, and reflect on things I was not confident about. I have grown through the programme – I had to come prepared! I gained confidence to transition from an operational mindset to a strategic mindset. My mentor saw a great transition in me in a short space of time.

GROUP MENTORS

- It was an absolute pleasure – we challenged each other, and we implemented together. Mentees planned and took steps to reach their goals. The mentees were courageous!
- We learned a lot as mentors, it was not just a one-way journey. I hope what we shared has laid a foundation for mentees to grow in their lives not only in work. I would like this to continue. I would like to see the mentees grow and develop.

LESSONS LEARNED

The following are the lessons learned from feedback from the weekly Operations meetings, mentor and mentee feedback on connect calls, and feedback from surveys and calls from our Relationship Agent:

Theme	Mitigation and recommendations going forward
Timing of programme – the mentorship programme kicked off towards the end of 2023, with most groups hosting their first meeting in November. There was great momentum from the launch into the first meeting, but groups seemed to struggle to maintain that momentum after the December holiday period.	The Ops team refreshed the programme by sending a welcome back email in January and scheduling online mentor and mentee connect calls to engage the participants to regain momentum. Future programs should be scheduled to kick off when holidays will not disrupt the flow of the programme.
The group mentorship format – despite the mentor and mentee appeals saying that the model would be group mentorship, some people understood it would be one-on-one. Two senior members of staff felt that they would not fit into a group as they would not be with their peers.	We believe the confusion of the model should be less of an issue going forward now that the model is more widely known. To accommodate the two senior members of staff, we created two one-on-one mentorship relationships which worked well. Going forward, we need to communicate more clearly during the participant appeal process, onboarding and orientation process what group mentorship is, its advantages and value, and how and why the programme is set up the way it is.
Communication of the programme objectives to IDC staff – IDC management team expressed concerns that some participants may have been misguided that the programme would promote their career growth within the IDC rather than their personal and professional development	We emphasized during the launch that the programme is about the individual's growth and development and feeling of belonging in the IDC. We should clearly communicate the intent of the programme and the advantages of attending in the original appeal, and throughout the onboarding, orientation, and launch.
Gathering feedback – although the feedback we received was generally positive to very positive, the team struggled throughout to get feedback from the busy participants. There was a low response rate to the platform surveys, making it difficult to track participant engagement and impact.	With the low survey response rate, we decided that NMM would contact the participants telephonically to gather feedback. Although Jillian helped by getting the contact details, the team continued to struggle to get time with the participants to get their feedback. We also appointed an ambassador in each group to keep us apprised of the attendance and health of the group, but their feedback was also very low. What ultimately worked were mentor and mentee connect calls and the use within the groups of WhatsApp groups. Going forward we suggest: • Scheduling regular mentor and mentee connect calls to gather feedback and add value with some learning • NMM setting up WhatsApp groups for each group and including a member of our staff who can monitor the activity • NMM facilitators join each group at regular intervals to gather feedback.

ANNEXURE: PARTNERSHIPS

Name	Role
GROUP 1	
Fikile Mkansi	Mentee
Luyanda Dlamini	Mentee
Thethiwe Makgasane	Mentee
kagiso moepye	Mentee
Lloyd Hlengani	Mentor
Japhet Mudau	Mentor
GROUP 2	
Kulani Mhlanga	Mentee
Tebogo Maditsi	Mentee
Kgomotso Mokobane	Mentee
Morgan Le Breton	Mentee
Fikile Nxumalo	Mentee
Phemelo Koloti	Mentee
Bilal Hoosen	Mentor
Refilwe Sekutu	Mentor
GROUP 3	
Khuliso Nemaheni	Mentee
Mpho Ngake	Mentee
Malusi Nkambule	Mentee
Nandipha Mphale	Mentee
Nonhlanhla Ndala	Mentee
Gavin Smith	Mentor
Nathan Fredericks	Mentor
GROUP 4	
Kgakgamatso Mohutsiwa	Mentee
Noxolo Vezi	Mentee
Nomzamo Mbeje	Mentee
Bukeka Nqenqa	Mentee
Lerato Mangope	Mentor
Chawulani Ndimande	Mentor
GROUP 5	
lizzy Kale	Mentee

Name	Role
Chanelle Leukes	Mentee
Anza Mafereka	Mentee
Maryam Suliman	Mentee
Imtiaz Goondiwalla	Mentor
Chisakula Kaputu	Mentor
GROUP 6	
Nonhlanhla Hugo	Mentee
Carol Singo	Mentee
Thabiso Kgotle	Mentee
Ntombizethu Zithobile Mngoma	Mentee
Refilwe Chaka	Mentor
Tebogo Vincent	Mentor
GROUP 7	
Paseka Moloi	Mentee
Adivhaho Singo	Mentee
Sauline Ngomane	Mentee
Miranda Ntimane	Mentee
Ngwanapedi Chatazo Seerane	Mentee
Suzette Soetwater	Mentee
Thatisi Manamela	Mentor
Nontobeko Marumo	Mentor
GROUP 8	
Benrose Chauke	Mentee
Jackson Nkeane	Mentee
Kedibone Moeketsi	Mentee
RHULANI LORRAINE CHAUKE	Mentee
Dimakatso Mabuela	Mentee
Lebohang Mpendu	Mentor
Peter Mokomele	Mentor
GROUP 9	
Nokuthula Mngomezulu	Mentee
Rionette Raphahlelo	Mentee
Rethabile Ramphalile	Mentee

Name	Role
Busisiwe Khuluse	Mentee
Marianna Papadopoulos	Mentor
Pieter de Beer	Mentor
GROUP 10	
Reshoketswe Maepa	Mentee
Letumile Sebolai	Mentee
Lindelwa Ngonyama	Mentee
Donovan Mekgwe	Mentee
Rika Gopichund	Mentor
GROUP 11	
Kashifa Burke	Mentee
Thando Nyaka	Mentee
Rika Gopichund	Mentee
Zola Sibusiso Qupe	Mentee
Ilze Adonis	Mentor
Kugan Thaver	Mentor
ONE-ON-ONES	
Naomi Mtshali	Mentee
Dave Wilson	Mentor
Mmeme Mhlahlo	Mentee
Patience Mushungwa	Mentor